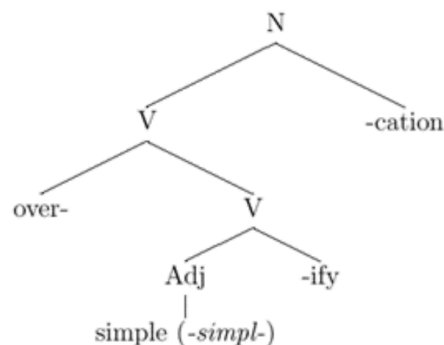


MORPHOLOGY

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1 Basic terminology

- morphology is the study of word formation
- the **lexicon** is the mental dictionary that stores information about words
- words belong to different **lexical categories**:
 - **nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs** are open classes of words
 - **pronouns, determiners, prepositions, and conjunctions** are closed classes of words
- a **morpheme** is a minimal unit of language that has meaning, e.g. *boy, run, -s, -ed*
- the morphemes of a word fall into two basic categories:
 - a **root** is the core of a word that contributes the basic meaning
 - additional elements that attach to a root and modify its meaning are called **affixes**
 - in word formation, the base that an affix attaches to is called a **stem**
- note: in the word *industrialize*, *industry* is the root, while *industrial* is the stem for the affix *-ize*
- there are four ways that affixes can attach to their base:
 - a **prefix** attaches before the root/stem, e.g. *un-, anti-, pre-*
 - a **suffix** attaches after the root/stem, e.g. *-ity, -ed, -ation*
 - a **circumfix** has two parts, one that comes before and one that comes after the root/stem
 - an **infix** attaches inside the root/stem, e.g. *<um>* in *fumikas* ‘to be strong’ in Bontoc
- affixes can also be classified as **inflectional affixes** or **derivational affixes**
 - inflectional affixes do not change the category of the stem, while derivational affixes do
- word formation occurs hierarchically and not linearly, for example:



- the different surface representations of a morpheme are called **allomorphs**
 - e.g. *in-* in *indirect*, *im-* in *impossible*, *in-* in *incorrect*
 - allomorphs are typically conditioned by phonological processes, e.g. place assimilation

2 Types of morphemes

- there are different ways that morphemes can be classified, many that have overlapping meanings
- **free morphemes** are ones that can stand on their own, e.g. *boy, run*
bound morphemes are ones that must attach to another morpheme, e.g. *-s, -ed*
- **content morphemes** serve semantic functions and denote things, object, events
functional morphemes serve grammatical functions such as tense, conjunction, number
- **open classes** are lexical categories in which new words can be easily added, e.g. nouns, verbs
closed classes are lexical categories in which new words cannot be easily added, e.g. prepositions
- **roots** are the semantic cores of words, e.g. *love, cat*
affixes attaches to roots to modify their meanings, e.g. *re-, in-*
- **inflectional affixes** express grammatical phenomena like number, gender, tense, e.g. *-ed, -ing*
derivational affixes create new meanings to the stem it attaches to, e.g. *ity-, -ness, -ify*
- note: not all roots are free (e.g. *atroc-* in *atrocitiy* and *atrocious*), but all affixes are bound

3 Morphological processes

- the process in which a word is modified to create a new word is called a **morphological process**
 - **affixation** is the attachment of affixes to a stem
 - **compounding** is the combination of two different words to form a new word
 - * e.g. *ice cream, girlfriend, greenhouse, salesman*
 - **reduplication** is a process where new words are formed by doubling part or all of a word
 - * e.g. *kirmizi* ‘red’ and *kikirmizi* ‘very red’ in Turkish
 - **stem alternation** is where internal modification to a root occurs
 - * e.g. *sing* and *sang, man* and *men, goose* and *geese*
 - **suppletion** is the use of two different roots for different forms of the same word
 - * e.g. *go* and *went, good* and *better, bad* and *worse*

4 Morphological types of languages

- languages can broadly be classified based on the types of morphemes and morphological processes
- an **analytic (or isolating) language** consist of mostly free morphemes
 - * e.g. the concept of plurality is expressed through independent morphemes in Mandarin
- a **synthetic language** have a mix free and bound morphemes that attach and form larger words
 - in **agglutinating languages** each morpheme mostly conveys one piece of information
 - * e.g. *ev-ler-iniz-den* ‘house-PL-your-from’ which means “from your houses” in Turkish
 - in **fusional languages** each morpheme often conveys several pieces of information
 - * e.g. *-s* meaning third person, singular, present tense in English
- a **polysynthetic language** has highly complex words that can convey full sentences
 - * e.g. *tuntu-ssu-qatar-ni-ksaite-ngqigg-tuq* ‘reindeer-hunt-FUT-say-NEG-again-he’ which means “he had not yet said again that he was going to hunt reindeer” in Yupik